

move closer to Bangladesh in matters concerning trade, commerce, tourism and cultural exchanges. There is plenty of scope for improving relations between the two countries.

DBN MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Hits and Misses

Indian hockey is on the verge of collapse if quick steps are not taken to revitalise its existence ("Plucky Strike", January 25). Indian hockey needs to be liberated from unelected power brokers. What hurts players most is that even when good sponsorship deals are struck, their rewards are negligible and payments erratic. For the kismet of hockey to change, the infrastructure needs to be improved. Let us hope the administrators wake up to the poignant fact that we are leisurely but certainly losing out on the world stage.

VINOD C. DIXIT,
Ahmedabad

An in-depth study of the affairs of the national game would clearly reveal that corrupt politicians, arrogant bureaucrats and autocratic police officials are responsible for the shameful condition of hockey in the country. In future, it should be ensured that only experienced sportspersons are allowed to handle the affairs of various sports bodies, including hockey.

A.K. SHARMA, *Chandigarh*

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Divisive Politics

Religion is considered an indispensable and cardinal fulcrum of human life and societies ("The Faithful Departed", January 25). That is why most political parties do not even think twice before using it as a card to take a moral high ground against their rivals. This deplorable propensity among politicians is of great dismay to the country that has traditionally celebrated its cultural and

Gowda because he received all abuses in capacity of being the head of the state ("Digging in the Dirt", January 25). It is also high time the Central Government initiated necessary recovery proceedings of IAF dues against Gowda. Leaders owing money to the government should not be allowed to contest elections.

MADHU AGRAWAL, *Delhi*

Tweet Nothings

Shashi Tharoor spoke the truth about the Gandhi



MANDAR DEODHAR/www.indiatodayimages.com

“For a crowded city like Mumbai, it is advisable that the metro lines should be underground. This would not only prevent traffic jams but will also be more environment-friendly.”

MAHESH KAPASI, *via www.indiatoday.in*

religious diversities. Religion-based politics is often used as divide and rule tactic. Its harms are innumerable and it is up to the citizenry to voice its opinions against such tactics.

INDU SHANKAR, *Varanasi*

Language Issue

Karnataka Chief Minister B.S. Yeddyurappa must not forgive H.D. Deve

family and it did not go well with them ("Mister Twister", January 25). He is not Rahul Gandhi that the Singhvis and Jayanthis would come to his rescue when he makes a faux pas. After serving in the UN, he must be feeling claustrophobic in the corridors of power.

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA,
Mysore

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

APRIL 1-15, 1980

End of the Boom

The huge yellow sign states that the project is the proposed construction of 50 deluxe "villas". The site is situated in the heart of Dubai, the commercial hub of the UAE. Dwarfed by the forest of gigantic cranes and bulldozers, sprouts the construction camp—an ungainly row of clapboard shacks from which the faint strains of Indian film music drift across the desert sand. Each shack is about 10 ft by 12 ft. Inside is a tightly-packed jigsaw puzzle of cots, seven in all. One corner of the shack has been converted into makeshift kitchen—a soot blackened kerosene stove, some aluminium pots and pans and a row of Dalda tins and packets of Pakistani spices take up the space. A narrow path meanders between the beds. The flimsy walls of the shack reveal the nationality of the occupants—they display cheap, garish pin-ups of busty south Indian stars. On one wall, Hema Malini and Zeenat Aman flank a calendar portraying Guru Nanak. And, perched incongruously alongside a row of scented hair oil bottles, is an empty case of Buchanan's Scotch Whisky.

by Dilip Bobb



AN INDIAN
WASHING A CAR
OUTSIDE THE
IMMIGRATION
OFFICE IN DUBAI